

Jake Ruth

Engineer and Y Combinator W22 founder.

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13 years shipping software across full-stack, infrastructure, and from-scratch products. Founded Stock Unlock (YC W22), a B2C fintech for retail stock research and portfolio tracking. Grew the team to eight and the customer base to thousands across 100+ countries. It runs profitably today with a lean team handling day-to-day.

EXPERIENCE

Co-founder & Engineer, Stock Unlock (YC W22)

2021–Apr 2026

Stock and ETF research, valuation, and portfolio tracking for retail investors. Profitable freemium B2C SaaS. Backed by Y Combinator (W22), Goodwater Capital, and others.

- Built the platform end-to-end across five years: React + Vite web, iOS and Android (Expo), Python API on AWS Lambda + Fargate.
- Founded the company and shipped the public launch in December 2021. Led the YC W22 interview, raised \$1.3M+ seed, built and managed an eight-person team across engineering, marketing, growth, customer support, and more; handed off to a profitable lean operating team in early 2026.
- Designed, built, reviewed, or architected every production system: brokerage integrations, Portfolio Tracker, Stock Scores, Stripe + RevenueCat billing across 100+ countries, stock and ETF screener and in-app search, referrals, and more.
- Operated as full-stack founder beyond engineering: investor communications, hiring and firing, vendor contracts, fintech conferences, SEO and AI-search strategy, product calls, and customer support.
- Authored team coding standards across web, mobile, backend, and testing. Built AI-agent governance for Cursor and Claude Code: custom agent skills and pre-commit hooks gating agent commits on lint and type-checks.

RECENT AI WORK *post-Opus 4.5*

- Internal AI agent system: custom Discord-controlled OpenHands harness on EC2 with system prompts and twelve hand-authored source guides baking Stock Unlock's architecture, deploys, and standards into the agent. `/code`: ask → plan → code (FE/BE/infra) → screenshotted GitLab MR with instruction-enforced human-in-the-loop gates and code-side skip detection on the screenshot step. `/ask`: read-only across the same sources. Two model tiers (Sonnet, MiniMax); deny-first IAM, per-command Postgres roles.
- X poster: self-improving X-content agent for Stock Unlock's account, with competitor accounts pulled via the X API as voice and topic reference. LangGraph pipeline drafts and fact-checks each post; LangMem optimizer rewrites the system prompt nightly from human feedback and live engagement. React admin UI for human review, edits, and feedback.
- Replaced Customer.io with self-hosted AWS SES in 27 days alongside other priorities: handles user-action-triggered campaigns and one-time broadcasts, plus a self-serve composer with an AI workflow for non-engineers to compose custom emails. 1M+ emails/year.
- Marketing infrastructure: replaced Webflow with a self-hosted codebase built with Claude Code, where non-technical designers prototype landing pages with AI agents and engineers review and merge. 20× content footprint, programmatic SEO across keyword and region pages, Playwright-based SEO regression checker.

Senior Software Engineer, Oscar Health

Mar 2017–Jun 2021

Promoted from Software Engineer, Jan 2020

Joined ~50-engineer org under Alan Warren (ex-Google Apps); left at ~200, through Oscar's IPO and 100K+ → ~1M member growth.

- Owned 12+ production back-end services across Python, Go, gRPC / Thrift, and Postgres, plus the React front-end for the entire internal care-ops site that grew from a few dozen to hundreds of staff in Tempe, AZ. On-call across all of them by departure.
- Beyond team scope, contributed company-wide: shipped to the internal frontend component library, ran internal codelabs, refined the technical interview process.
- Inherited and shipped a complex third-party analytics integration the company had under-scoped at contract: custom Docker images, threaded through the company stack, pulled in SRE, security, and engineering stakeholders to land it.

- Built **Emotiqueue** with a co-worker: internal Slack bot that became an Oscar culture artifact (3K+ emoticons, 50+ commands, contributors from across the company).
- Mentored newer engineers; participated in 2 team splits during rapid org scaling.

Co-founder & CTO, Youni Inc. (part-time, nights and weekends alongside CommerceHub)

Late 2014–Jul 2016

Full-time

Jul 2016–Dec 2016

- Co-founded a college-localized social-media iOS app on early React Native (v0.13 / 0.14). Launched at SUNY Albany and Binghamton; ~4,000 downloads, 3,500 users, 20,000+ posts at peak.

Software Engineer (intern → full-time), CommerceHub

Nov 2013–Jul 2016

- Groovy / Grails on the back, early-pre-hooks React on the front, code-review-first culture. First real engineering job. Intern through senior year of college plus a full-time summer, then FT for one year and seven days before going full-time on Youni.

STACK

LANGUAGES Python · TypeScript / JavaScript · React · React Native · Node.js · SQL · Shell (Bash, ZSH). Familiar with Go.

INFRA AWS (Lambda, Fargate, ECS, EC2, ECR, S3, SES, Aurora, DynamoDB, Cognito, CloudWatch, Secrets Manager, EventBridge) · Postgres · MySQL · Docker · Playwright · Stripe · Snaptrade · Sentry · PostHog · Google Analytics · Google Search Console · GitHub · GitLab

AI Claude Code · CMUX · Codex · OpenHands · Cursor (occasional) · MiniMax · Pinecone. Familiar with LangChain, LangGraph, LangMem. Models day-to-day: Claude (Opus, Sonnet) · GPT-5.5 · Gemini · Grok

Daily AI flow: Claude Code primary, Codex situational, lighter Cursor / Gemini / Grok use; constantly reassessing tool fit.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science & Applied Mathematics, University at Albany (SUNY)

2011–2015

Dean's List every semester. CS Department teaching assistant, 2013–2015. ACM (CS Club) President, 2013–2015.